Bridger Creative Science E.S.

Changes beginning in 2028-29

WHAT'S HAPPENING?

- Bridger Creative Science would change from a K-8 to a K-5 school.
- The school would keep both its neighborhood school area and its Creative Science special-focus choice program.
- Current middle grade students would be reassigned to Harrison Park Middle School or could choose to return to their neighborhood middle school.

WHY IS PPS CONSIDERING THIS?

- Steady student numbers: Changing to K-5 boosts middle school enrollment in neighborhood schools while protecting the Creative Science unique learning program.

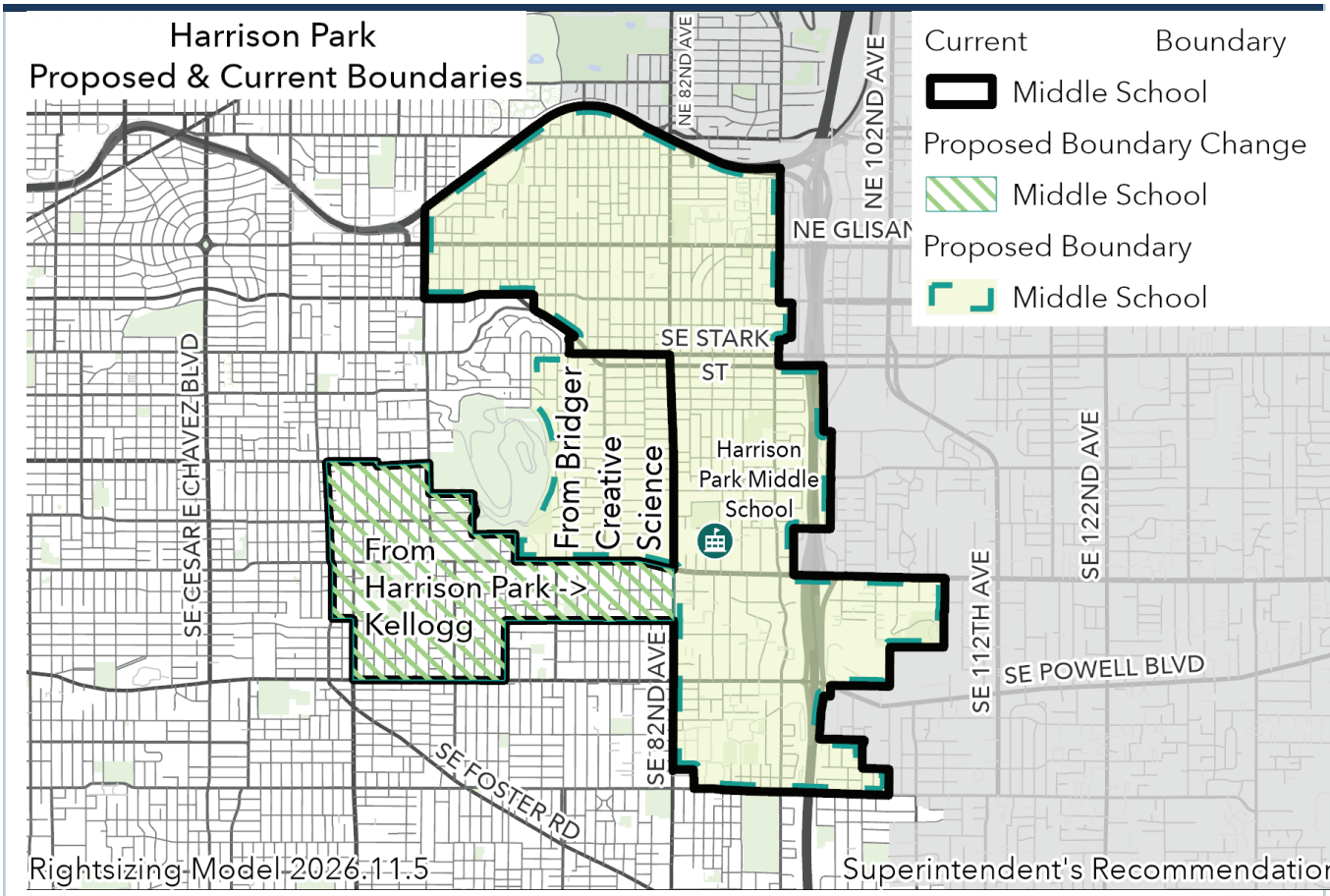
WHAT ELSE WAS CONSIDERED?

- Preserving student enrollment: Keeping both the neighborhood area and the special-focus choice program protects student enrollment and honors the school's unique community history.
- Southeast Guiding Coalition: Because of many recent changes, the decision was made to preserve the special-focus choice portion of Bridger Creative Science.

WHAT WOULD STUDENTS GAIN?

- Focused programming: Elementary students benefit from a school and playground designed for younger children.
- Richer middle school options: 6th-8th grade students gain access to broader middle school electives and learning options at a comprehensive middle school.

WHERE WOULD THE SCHOOL BOUNDARY BE?



SCHOOL BUILDING CAPACITY & ENROLLMENT

	Functional Capacity	Utilization %	Historical Peak Enrollment	Current Enrollment (2026-2027)
Current School	510	88.2%	531 (2017-18)	403

Projected enrollment

School Year	2027-28	2028-29	2029-30	2030-31	2031-32
Status Quo/No Change	450	444	440	421	415
Recommendation	450	302	310	310	301

ENROLLMENT AND TRANSFER

- Neighborhood students: 5th-7th grade students residing in the Bridger Creative Science attendance area will enroll at Harrison Park M.S.

- PPS transfer students: 5th-7th grade students attending Bridger Creative Science but not residing in the attendance area will enroll at Harrison Park or may transfer to their neighborhood school by home address.

WHO WOULD THE SCHOOL SERVE?

Option	Poverty	Special education	Multilingual services	Underserved racial groups	Title I
Status Quo/No Change	27.1%	21.7%	4.3%	14.3%	Not Title 1
Recommendation	24.1%	20.6%	3.5%	12.5%	Not Title 1

ACADEMIC PROGRAM TRANSITIONS

- Academic Programs: School year 2028-29: Bridger Creative Science will house only students in grades K-5. Based on current enrollment projections, there will be 2 classrooms at each grade level. Students will receive PE, Arts, and Library/Media instruction each week. Based on enrollment, the school will be supported by a part-time counselor.
- Special Education: Currently, Bridger has 2.5 Learning Center classes. There are no changes to this model for the 2027-2028 school year.
- Student and Family Supports: Currently, Morrison Child and Family Services is the Bridger Creative Science's School-Based Mental Health Partner.

School transition supports: Teams from Central Office have developed a framework for implementing Rightsizing. This includes a menu of transition supports for all impacted school communities. This work is informed by lessons learned by districts across the country that have had successful school consolidations. The implementation framework includes guidance on merging academic programs and school-based teams, (such as Instructional Leadership, Climate, PTAs and others) tools, resources, and timelines. The framework includes timelines for merging school communities and onboarding staff, families and students to their new campuses. It also includes staffing timelines and plans for packing and moving furniture and instructional resources. This comprehensive framework will be shared with the community in December. If the Board of Education votes to proceed with Rightsizing for fall 2027, Central Office teams will begin working with school communities in January to implement transition supports appropriate to each community.